RESEARCH SHOWCASE · NOVEMBER 2026

The Tests Passed. The Grader Said No.

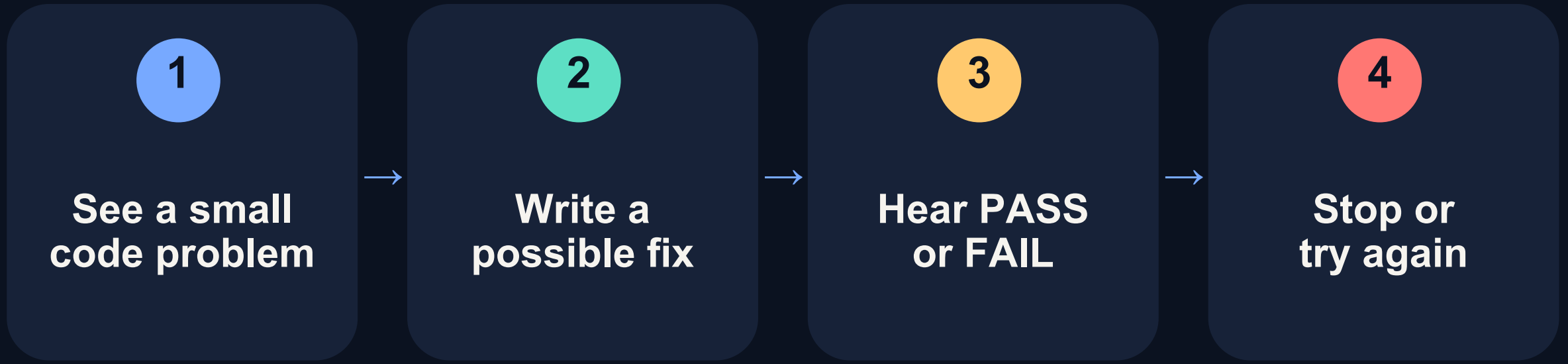
Checking the checker in AI security repair

OUR TESTS: PASS → FINAL SCORE: FAIL

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When should an AI stop trying?



A misleading score makes that behavior hard to judge.

Why it matters: people use feedback to decide whether to trust AI-written code.

METHOD

Our checker had two separate decisions

40
saved sessions

1
local AI model

5
small task types

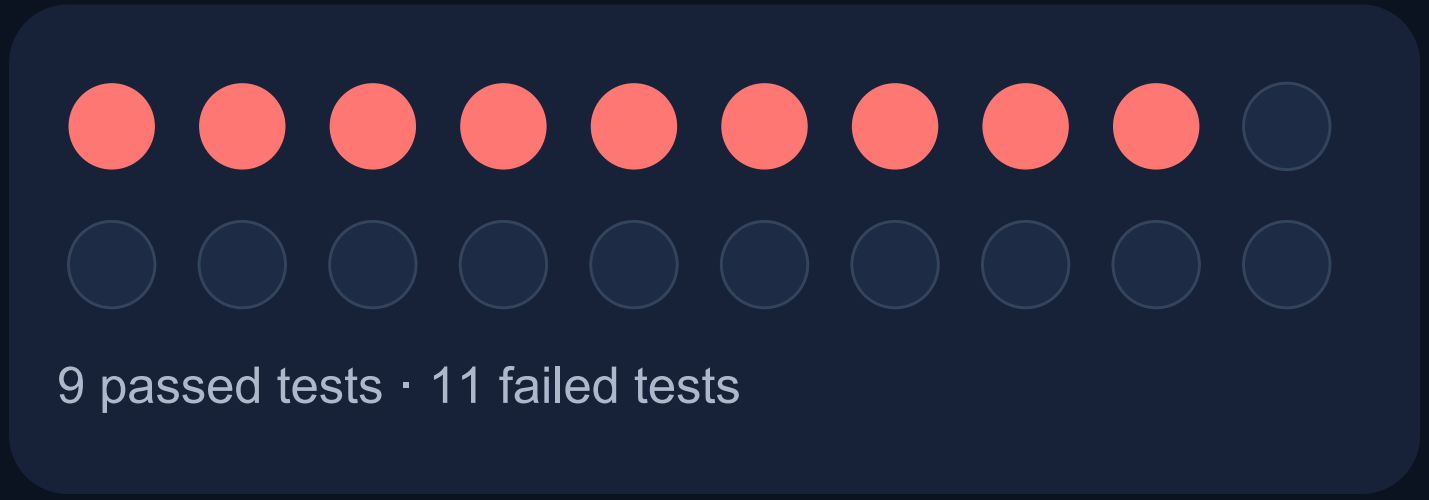
Run the code tests → **Accept or reject**

Did this code pass our written checks?

20 sessions: our hidden “reject everything” rule

We added this rule. The AI could not see it.

9 of 20 passed the tests — and still got FAIL



9 / 20

passed tests, still rejected

All 20 were rejected. The hidden rule overrode the test result.

Passing these limited tests does not prove the code secure.

A stop request was not the end

14 sessions requested a stop immediately after a public PASS.



0

further logged repair attempts

2 min 8 sec

Median after acknowledgement in 13 sessions.
The 14th timed out and is excluded from this median.

The old controller waited for another final signal. We verified that path in a scripted test.

Before judging the AI, check the grader.

WHAT WE LEARNED

A score is only as useful as the system behind it.

WHAT WE BUILT

Per-step records + a tested immediate-stop path.

NEXT: independent task review → broader paired trials

Same checked code. True PASS or false FAIL. Does the fix survive?

Small pilots are exploratory. The larger study is still ahead.